

Everything gets crossed out

The X is already the loudest thing AnNIXion owns. It is the hero letterform in the wordmark, it is the dead eyes on the wall, and it is what an operator leaves behind. This board is the whole system: one palette lifted off the wallpaper, one set of hand-drawn marks, one face, and a rule for every surface the distribution puts in front of you.

a n N I X i o n

OFFENSIVE SECURITY DISTRIBUTION

"The environment for operators who refuse to wing it"



01 Name and mark

Always AnNIXion in running text – one word, capital A, capital NIX. Never Annixion, never ANNIXION.

Wordmark	anNIXion, NIX in #FF0033
Descriptor	OFFENSIVE SECURITY DISTRIBUTION, boxed in a hairline red rule
Tagline	README and release notes only, never the lockup
Logo	Nix snowflake under a datamosh glitch – a hero image, never an icon
Launcher mark	annixion-logo – the same snowflake drawn to the mark rules
Codename	One word in RELEASE_NAME beside the number in VERSION

In the wordmark, the three letters of NIX carry the signature red and the rest stays light, so the Nix lineage is legible without saying it. Letterspacing is wide (0.30em), weight is light: it is a wordmark, not a headline.

THE X – THE RECURRING DEVICE



in the mark



as the eyes on the wall



over a finished target

Three places that were never talking to each other. The X is the crossed-out letter in the wordmark, the eyes on the graffiti smiley, and the shape an operator draws over a target that is done. Making it the system cost nothing – it was already there.

DARK GROUND ONLY

The datamosh logo is light artwork on transparency: it vanishes on any light surface, and at the 32px the panel gives it the glitch bars collapse into a smear. The panel wears annixion-logo instead. Because that is a stroke rather than baked pixels, it is also the first form of the mark that can be recoloured for a light surface.

02 Palette

A sober red-on-Nord chrome runs the interface; a neon graffiti wall runs behind it.

CHROME — THE INTERFACE

#0E0F13 Deepest ground home/zsh/omp-theme.nix:3	#1A1D24 Raised surface home/zsh/omp-theme.nix:3	#2E323D Segment, divider home/zsh/omp-theme.nix:3	#FF0033 The signature accent 18 uses across home/	#DFE4EA Primary text home/zsh/omp-theme.nix:3	#301212 Root ground home/konsole.nix:55

GRAFFITI — SAMPLED FROM ASSETS/WALLPAPER/

#000000 Wall ground — 62% of wallpaper pixels	#0F5AE6 Cobalt — the figure	#F213A0 Magenta — spray tags, smiley, jester	#33E62B Acid green — the throw-up tag

The mark colours are lifted off the wall, so the menu speaks the wallpaper's language the moment it opens. Motifs live on pure black and nowhere else, one spray colour per motif, never two in the same mark.

03 Semantic classes

Colour encodes what running the tool does to the target, not which kill-chain phase it sits in – the menu already tells you the phase.

 Passive #33E62B	 Probe #FFD000	 Offensive #FF0033
Sends nothing to the target theHarvester · Whois · SecLists contrast 10.7:1 on the #14171D menu ground	Touches the target and shows in their logs, no access attempted Nmap · dig · WhatWeb · Gobuster · ffuf · Gqrx contrast 12.2:1 on the #14171D menu ground	Attempts access, execution or credential compromise Metasploit · sqlmap · Hydra · Hashcat · Aircrack-ng contrast 4.5:1 on the #14171D menu ground
 Forensic #4A90FF	 Reverse #F213A0	 Utility #7A8494
Reads evidence after the fact, never reaches the network Volatility 3 · Autopsy · Wireshark contrast 5.8:1 on the #14171D menu ground	Pulls a compiled artifact apart Ghidra · Binwalk contrast 4.6:1 on the #14171D menu ground	Not a tool of the trade Kate · Ark · KCalc · Dolphin · Konsole contrast 4.8:1 on the #14171D menu ground

Red means the tool needs written authorisation behind it. That is the one class where the mark is a check on muscle memory rather than decoration. Phases 03 through 07 all land on offensive red, giving the menu an unbroken red band down its middle – the stretch where you are inside someone else's estate.

04 Session colours

The six classes say what a tool does to a target. A terminal does nothing to a target, so the terminal family is coloured by the session you are standing in instead.



Operator

#7A8494 · the operator's own shell



Root

#FF0033 · sudo -i, on the #301212 root profile



Nix shell

#7EBAE4 · nix develop, where the checks run

The values are the prompt's own – the session segment flips to accent red as root and to Nix blue inside a Nix shell (`home/zsh/omp-theme.nix:37`). The launcher and the shell it opens agree before you have typed anything.

COLOUR	VALUE	CONTRAST	SESSION
Utility	#7A8494	4.8:1	The operator's own shell
Elevated	#FF0033	4.5:1	root
Nix	#7EBAE4	8.6:1	Inside <code>nix develop</code>

Elevated repeats the signature red rather than introducing a seventh value: root is the one session that is dangerous to miss, and it should read as the same red the root Konsole background and the prompt already use. These two colours are the terminal family's alone – no tool mark may take them.

This is the elevation rule reaching one surface earlier. The root Konsole already changes the ground you are standing on once the window is open; colouring the launcher says it while the pointer is still over the menu.

05 Typography

JetBrains Mono is the display and interface face. Things you type should look typed.

DISPLAY · 46PX · -0.03EM

Everything gets crossed out

SECTION · 26PX · -0.02EM

The mark system

LABEL · 11PX · UPPERCASE · 0.12EM

SEMANTIC CLASSES

BODY · 16PX · 1.6

Say the consequence before the mechanism.

WORDMARK · LIGHT · 0.30EM — THE ONE PLACE TRACKING GOES WIDE

a n N I X i o n

ABCDEFGHIJKLM

NOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklm

nopqrstuvwxyz

0123456789

! ? @ # \$ % & * / \ < > { } []

Face `nerd-fonts.jetbrains-mono`, shipped in `home.nix`

Fallback `nerd-fonts.fira-code`

Display tracking `-0.03em` at display sizes

Labels `11px uppercase` at `0.12em`

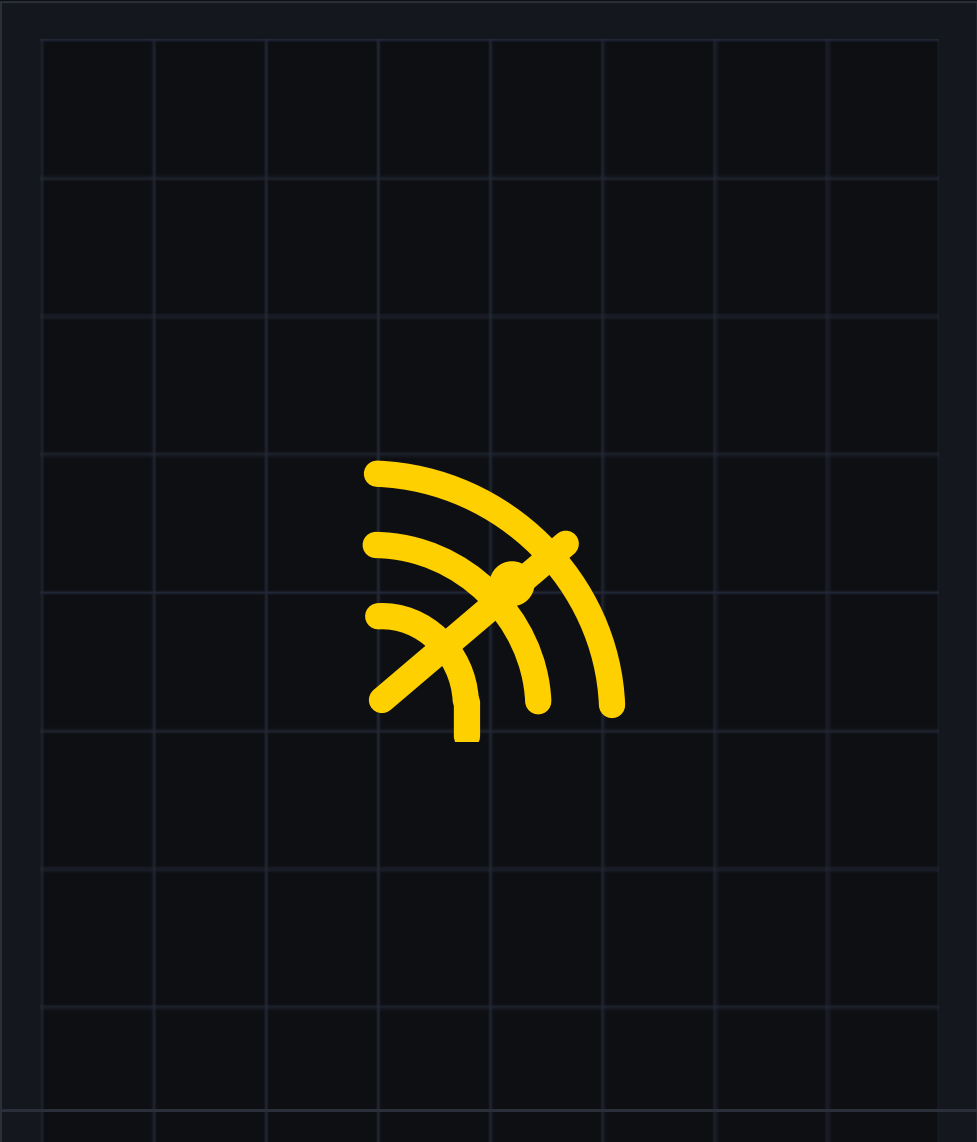
Wordmark `light weight`, `0.30em`

Category strings and paths keep the mono face — they are things you type, and should look typed. This board is set in the same face the system is.

06 The mark system

Every AnNIXion application and menu directory gets a single-colour line drawing filling its whole canvas. No container, no plate – the colour classifies, the silhouette identifies.

RULE	VALUE	WHY
Grid	24 × 24, drawing fills 21 × 21	1.5 units of air each side
Stroke	2.1, round cap and join	Lands at 1.93px when the menu draws 22px
Colour	Whole mark in one class colour	Colour classifies, silhouette identifies
Fills	Only for dots under 2.5 units	Anything larger becomes a blob at 16px
Detail budget	Five strokes or fewer	Spend the sixth on silhouette, never texture
Silhouette	Must differ from its classmates	Inside a class the colour is identical
Subject	What the tool does, never its logo	Upstream logos break the set
Naming	annixion-<tool>	Namespaced against upstream hicolor icons
Export	scalable/apps/annixion-<tool>.svg	One file per mark



07 The hand

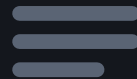
Adding a drip to a machine-perfect rectangle does not make it graffiti – it makes it a rectangle with a drip. The hand has to be in the geometry itself.



A window, and a window with a drip



A circle, and a circle that never closes



Three rules, and three rules no two of which are parallel



A box, and a box that has been crossed out

1 No straight lines UNIVERSAL

Every straight run bows by about half a unit, and no two are parallel. A hand cannot draw a true horizontal, and the eye reads the difference before it can name it. This does the most work.

3 The drip EARNED

One run of wet paint from the lowest edge that has room, 3-4.5 units, same stroke weight, rounded tip. The signature move.

2 No closed circles UNIVERSAL

Radii vary by up to half a unit around the turn, and the shape never quite meets itself – one gap where the marker lifted. Always on a curve, never on a straight run, never more than one per mark.

4 The X EARNED

Struck across anything the tool defeats, overshooting the shape it crosses. If the tool does not break the thing, it does not get the X.

Rules 1 and 2 are universal and apply to every mark in the set. Rules 3 and 4 are semantic and are earned. Corners and crossings overshoot their joins by up to a unit throughout – the marker keeps moving after the shape has ended.

08 Families

Where one application appears several times under different colours, every copy shares a single drawing and the colour carries the whole difference.

THE BROWSER PROFILES – ONE DRAWING, FOUR CLASSES



Unsafe Browser

utility · #7A8494



Red Team

offensive · #FF0033



OSINT

probe · #FFD000



Puppet Master

passive · #33E62B

Bound once at the top of `home/icons/marks.nix` and referenced by name, so a redraw cannot drift between the variants and a fifth variant costs no artwork at all – the two reserve classes below are two lines each.



forensic – reserved



reverse – reserved

Why not a globe. A globe is the more obvious browser drawing. At 22px it is indistinguishable from the Internet directory's own globe, which sits directly above it in the same menu – and both are grey. The window and tab is one stroke less obvious and unmistakably not that.



Internet – directory



Firefox – Unsafe Browser



Firefox – Red Team



Firefox – OSINT

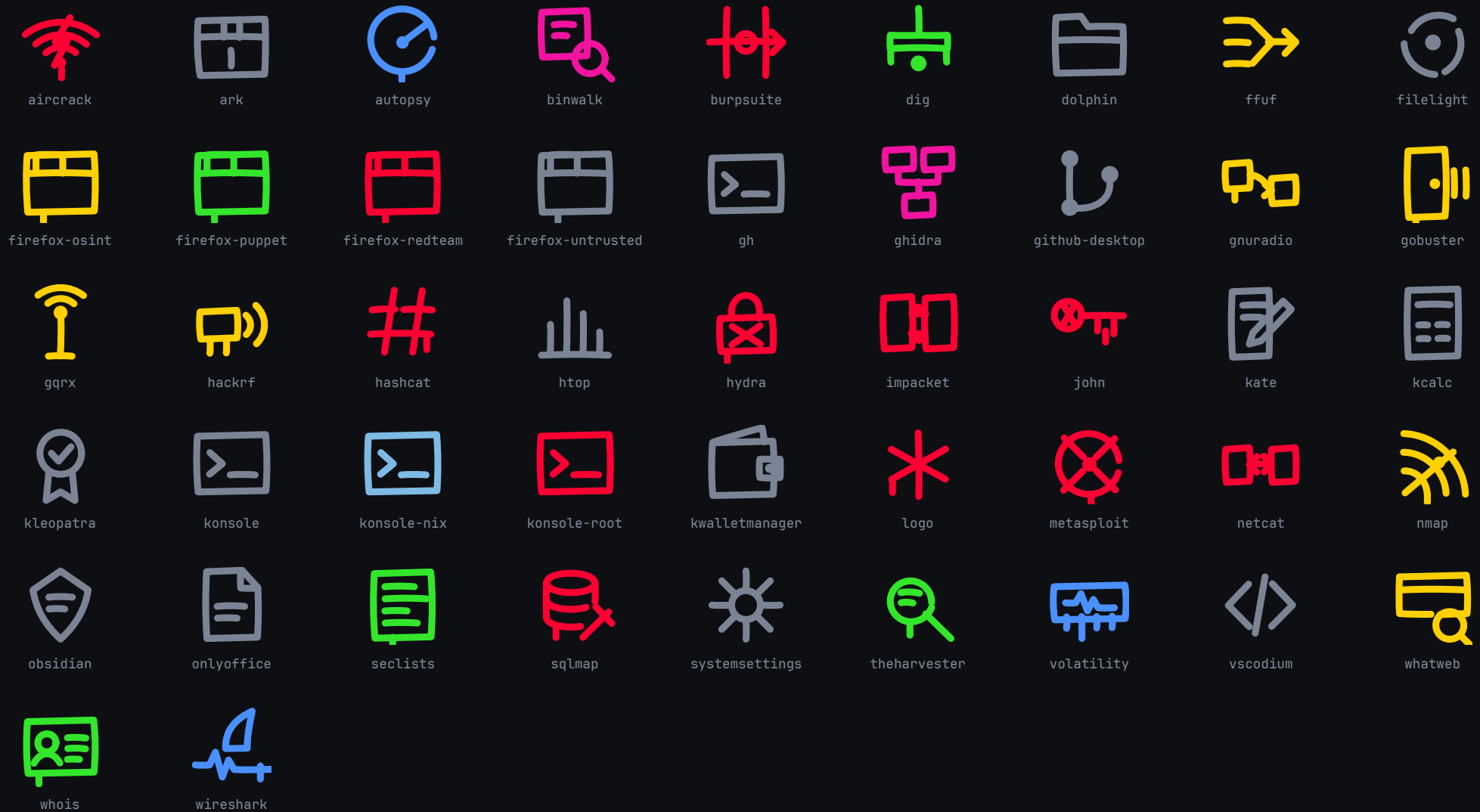


Firefox – Puppet Master

OSINT is amber rather than green deliberately: the profile drives a real browser at a real target, fetching their pages and landing in their logs. That is probe, not passive.

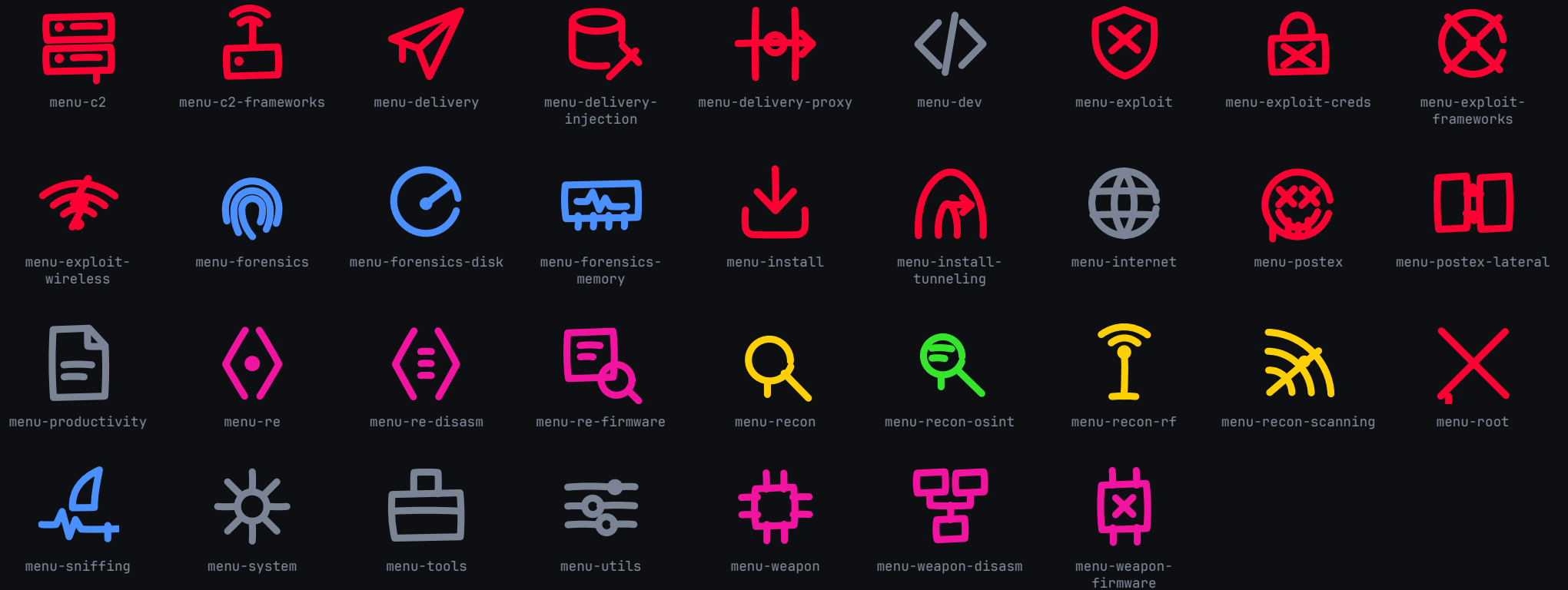
09 The set – applications

47 application marks. Colour is the class; every silhouette differs from its classmates.



10 The set – menu directories

34 directory marks, one per node of the kill-chain tree. A directory takes the colour of what it contains.



11 Motif vocabulary

The wallpapers carry a fixed cast. Reuse these rather than inventing new ones.



X-EYED SMILEY



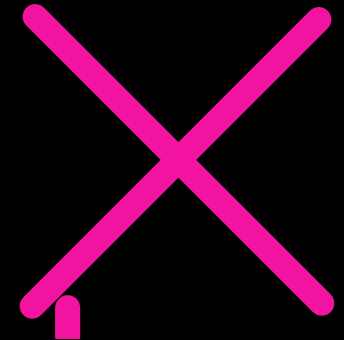
SKULL



404



THROW-UP TAG



THE X

Where they are allowed. Wallpaper, lock screen, ISO boot splash, fastfetch banner, README header, release art. Motifs live on pure black and nowhere else. They drip downward, never upward. One spray colour per motif, never two in the same mark.

Not the panel and not the menu – with one exception. The X-eyed smiley is the Post-Exploitation mark, because there it states something true rather than decorating. Motifs are drawn looser than tool marks: stroke 1.7, hand-weighted curves, allowed to overshoot much further.

12 Surfaces

A rule for every surface the distribution puts in front of you, from power-on to the desktop.

SURFACE	STATE	NOTES
Boot loader	THEMED	systemd-boot draws a text menu and takes no theme, so the mark's first appearance is the Plymouth splash
Login (SDDM)	THEMED	Breeze's greeter rebranded through theme.conf alone – no QML of our own
Lock screen	THEMED	wallpaper_2.png via home/plasma.nix:36
Desktop	THEMED	wallpaper_1.png, preserveAspectRatio on pure black
Panel	THEMED	32px, annixion-logo as launcher icon
Application menu	THEMED	42 entries, 34 directories, 81 marks
Terminal	THEMED	Konsole, 85% opacity with blur
Prompt	THEMED	oh-my-posh, chrome palette, red accent diamonds
fastfetch	THEMED	AnNIXion mark at width 30, keys and title in red
Browser profiles	THEMED	One mark in four class colours
README / GitHub	THEMED	Glitch banner, wordmark lockup, badge row
ISO	THEMED	Banner on black for both the syslinux and GRUB menus

Boot. `boot.loader.timeout` stays at 3 seconds. A splash that cannot be interrupted is a machine with no way back to an older generation. The splash is a Plymouth `script` theme copied into the `initrd`, so it must stay small.

Elevation. The root Konsole profile swaps the whole background to `#301212` rather than adding a warning icon. The rule generalises: privilege changes the surface you are standing on, never a decoration bolted onto it.

13 Rejected directions

What was tried, what it cost, and what replaced it. Kept because the next person to have the same idea deserves the measurement, not the argument.

The hexagonal badge

Every glyph seated in a coloured hexagon.

WHY NOT

The container spent 82% of the canvas on itself, leaving the drawing at 18% of the area and a 1.01px stroke once the menu rendered 22px. Two tools in the same class became a coloured hexagon with a smudge inside.

INSTEAD

Filling the canvas gives 4.2× the drawn area and 1.9× the stroke weight from the same drawings.

Rotating marks off-axis

A few degrees of tilt on every mark, for looseness.

WHY NOT

It reads as hand-drawn at 96px and as a rendering bug at 22px, and a menu column all leaning the same way looks broken rather than deliberate.

INSTEAD

The hand lives in the strokes, not the transform.

A globe for the browser profiles

The obvious drawing for a web browser.

WHY NOT

At 22px it is indistinguishable from the Internet directory's own globe, which sits directly above it in the same menu, and both are grey.

INSTEAD

The window and tab is one stroke less obvious and unmistakably not that.

A drip bolted onto machine geometry

Perfect rectangles, with paint added afterwards.

WHY NOT

Adding a drip to a machine-perfect rectangle does not make it graffiti – it makes it a rectangle with a drip.

INSTEAD

The hand has to be in the geometry itself, which is what devices 1 and 2 are for.

Our own SDDM greeter in QML

Full control over the login surface.

WHY NOT

A greeter that fails to load leaves no way into the machine.

INSTEAD

Breeze's greeter, rebranded through theme.conf – it is already tested by everyone running Plasma.

Shadowing upstream icon names

Drawing annixion marks under names like wireshark or ghidra, so pinned stock launchers wear them too.

WHY NOT

A mark filed under an upstream name silently wins the icon lookup for every application that asks for it, including ones we never drew for.

INSTEAD

Marks stay namespaced annixion-*, and tests/menu-icons.sh fails on any un-namespaced file in the theme. The six stock launchers pinned to the panel keep their upstream icons.

14 Voice

The wall is loud so the words do not have to be.

DO

- State what happened and what to do about it.
- Name things the way an operator does – *targets*, *hosts*, *captures*.
- Say the consequence before the mechanism, in commit messages and errors alike.
- Keep the dry register: the wall is loud so the words do not have to be.

DON'T

- Reach for hacker-movie voice – no “pwned”, no leetspeak, no skull emoji in output.
- Apologise in errors or hedge with “something went wrong”.
- Use the graffiti vocabulary in UI copy; it belongs on the wall, not in a dialog.
- Explain what a tool is in a menu label – the menu is for finding, not teaching.

15 How it is built

Reclassifying a tool is a one-word change. Redrawing one is a change to its body. Neither touches the menu.

<code>home/icons/marks.nix</code>	One entry per mark – a class and the 24-grid drawing. The two family bodies are bound in a <code>let</code> at the top and referenced by name.
<code>home/icons/default.nix</code>	Renders each into <code>scalable/apps/annixion-<name>.svg</code> , the class supplying the stroke colour, and emits an <code>index.theme</code> .
<code>home.nix</code>	Joins that theme with <code>SlotIcons</code> into the one directory <code>xdg.dataFile."icons"</code> owns.
<code>home/apps-menu.nix</code>	Names marks only by <code>annixion-<tool></code> and <code>annixion-menu-<slug></code> .
<code>tests/menu-icons.sh</code>	Fails on any <code>Icon=</code> that resolves nowhere, and on any un-namespaced file in the theme.

Adding a menu entry means adding its mark in the same commit. The test is the check that would have caught the four dead names the previous theme was carrying – `codium`, `wireshark`, `network-transmit-receive` and `media-removable`, all of which drew a blank placeholder.

Inheritance. The theme inherits `Slot-Dark-Icons`, `breeze-dark`, `Adwaita` and `hicolor`, so anything the set does not draw still falls back to a real icon rather than a blank.

One boundary. Six launchers pinned to the panel are stock desktop entries – Konsole, Dolphin, Burp Suite, Wireshark, Ghidra, Obsidian – because Plasma matches a window to a launcher by class and only the stock name resolves. They wear their upstream icons. Shadowing those names in our theme would capture the lookup for every application that asks for them, so the test forbids it.

Set in JetBrains Mono, the system's own face. Every mark on this board is read out of a built icon theme, not redrawn – regenerate with `branding/identity-board.sh`. The normative reference is `docs/visual-identity.md`.